

MARUWA (5344.T)

More cautious on earnings from FY3/28 mainly on capacity expansion costs; 2Q guidance achievement likely key to future share price performance; reiterate Buy

5344.T

12m Price Target: ¥81,000

Price: ¥55,630

Upside: 45.6%

We update our earnings estimates for MARUWA in this report. We lower our FY3/28-FY3/29 operating profit estimates by 7%/11% (FY3/27E unchanged). The revisions mainly reflect higher costs associated with capacity expansion for AI applications. In addition to the existing No. 1 plant, the No. 2 plant is progressing smoothly toward starting operations in 3Q3/27 (Oct-Dec). While the company may bring forward the start of operations at the No. 3 plant to 1H3/28 ([LINK](#)), we assume that it could start operations in 1Q3/28 (Apr-Jun), given the current tight supply/demand balance. In addition, we assume that additional capacity expansion will be necessary from FY3/30, as our FY3/29 AI-related sales estimate of ¥75 bn assumes all three plants will be operating normally. Considering the lead time required for plant construction, we assume an announcement will be made at the full-year FY3/27 results briefing as one scenario.

We think that achievement of implied 2Q operating profit guidance of ¥8.45 bn could be key to share price performance going forward. In recent quarters, operating profits have continued to miss guidance/consensus due to factors such as the impact of yields on AI-related products (4Q3/26 and 1Q3/27) and unexpected inventory adjustments for automotive products (2Q3/26). Heading into 2Q, the company said that yield issues for AI-related products had been completely resolved on the production and inventory fronts ([LINK](#)), and that it expected robust qoq sales growth for semiconductor applications as well ([LINK](#)). Therefore, we believe the true potential of these two applications, which have high contribution margin ratios, will finally be demonstrated. We see potential for a valuation-driven rise in the share price if the company posts 2Q operating profits in line with market expectations.

BUY

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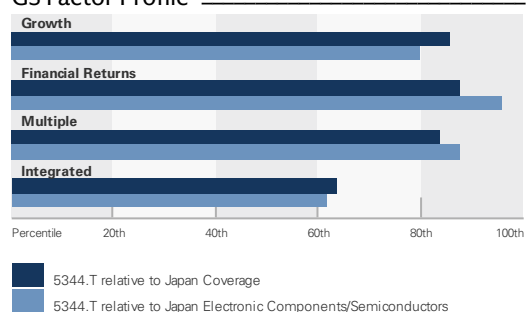
Key Data

Market cap: ¥686.4bn / \$4.4bn
Enterprise value: ¥599.7bn / \$3.8bn
3m ADTV: ¥7.4bn / \$46.0mn
Japan
Japan Electronic Components/Semiconductors
M&A Rank: 3
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes

GS Forecast

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Revenue (¥ bn)	74.5	93.3	125.0	143.5
Op. profit (¥ bn) New	25.0	35.0	53.0	63.0
Op. profit (¥ bn) Old	25.0	35.0	57.0	71.0
Op. profit CoE (¥ bn)	27.0	33.7	—	—
EPS (¥) New	1,471.9	2,032.5	3,048.8	3,613.4
EPS (¥) Old	1,471.9	2,041.6	3,283.7	4,074.1
P/E (X)	29.0	27.4	18.2	15.4
P/B (X)	3.6	4.0	3.3	2.8
CROCI (%)	18.3	23.6	29.6	30.5
	6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
EPS (¥)	361.9	462.2	558.7	614.6

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
See disclosures for details.

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BUY

MARUWA (5344.T)

Rating since Apr 3, 2024

Ratios & Valuation

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
P/E (X)	29.0	27.4	18.2	15.4
P/B (X)	3.6	4.0	3.3	2.8
FCF yield (%)	(1.1)	3.1	2.9	5.1
EV/EBITDAR (X)	15.1	14.3	9.5	7.6
EV/EBITDA (excl. leases) (X)	15.1	14.3	9.5	7.6
CROCI (%)	18.3	23.6	29.6	30.5
ROE (%)	13.2	15.8	19.9	19.6
Net debt/equity (%)	(45.7)	(50.7)	(50.6)	(55.2)
Net debt/equity (excl. leases) (%)	(45.7)	(50.7)	(50.6)	(55.2)
Interest cover (X)	—	—	—	—
Days inventory outst, sales	69.0	52.6	36.2	38.8
Receivable days	64.3	44.1	30.4	32.5
Days payable outstanding	37.3	31.6	24.5	27.3
DuPont ROE (%)	12.3	14.7	18.2	17.9
Turnover (X)	0.5	0.5	0.6	0.5
Leverage (X)	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.1
Gross cash invested (ex cash) (¥)	128.8	139.8	165.4	183.8
Average capital employed (¥)	68.1	82.3	93.3	106.8
BVPS (¥)	11,933.9	13,856.3	16,735.1	20,138.5

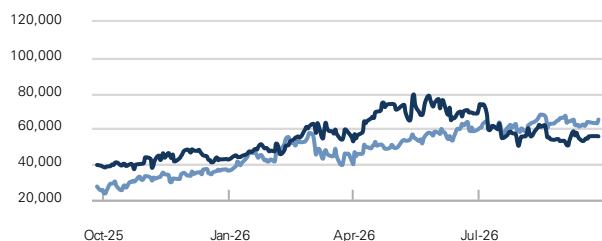
Growth & Margins (%)

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Total revenue growth	3.7	25.3	34.0	14.8
EBITDA growth	(4.4)	38.5	45.2	18.0
EPS growth	(5.6)	38.1	50.0	18.5
DPS growth	8.5	7.8	54.5	23.5
EBIT margin	33.5	37.5	42.4	43.9
EBITDA margin	40.7	45.0	48.8	50.2
Net income margin	24.4	26.9	30.1	31.1

Price Performance

5344.T (¥)

TOPIX



	3m	6m	12m
Absolute	(19.5)%	(6.7)%	38.8%
Rel. to the TOPIX	(21.7)%	(17.5)%	7.1%

Source: FactSet. Price as of 25 Sep 2026 close.

Income Statement (¥ bn)

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Total revenue	74.5	93.3	125.0	143.5
Cost of goods sold	(35.3)	(40.5)	(48.2)	(53.2)
SG&A	(12.6)	(16.0)	(21.8)	(25.1)
R&D	(1.6)	(1.8)	(2.0)	(2.2)
Other operating inc./exp.)	—	—	—	—
EBITDA	30.3	42.0	61.0	72.0
Depreciation & amortization	(5.3)	(7.0)	(8.0)	(9.0)
EBIT	25.0	35.0	53.0	63.0
Net interest inc./exp.)	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6
Income/(loss) from associates	—	—	—	—
Pre-tax profit	26.4	36.0	54.0	64.0
Provision for taxes	(8.3)	(10.9)	(16.4)	(19.4)
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Preferred dividends	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	18.2	25.1	37.6	44.6
Post-tax exceptionals	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	18.2	25.1	37.6	44.6
EPS (basic, pre-exception) (¥)	1,471.9	2,032.5	3,048.8	3,613.4
EPS (diluted, pre-exception) (¥)	1,471.9	2,032.5	3,048.8	3,613.4
EPS (basic, post-exception) (¥)	1,471.9	2,032.5	3,048.8	3,613.4
EPS (diluted, post-exception) (¥)	1,471.9	2,032.5	3,048.8	3,613.4
DPS (¥)	102.0	110.0	170.0	210.0
Div. payout ratio (%)	6.9	5.4	5.6	5.8

Balance Sheet (¥ bn)

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Cash & cash equivalents	67.2	86.5	104.4	137.1
Accounts receivable	13.7	8.9	11.9	13.7
Inventory	16.3	10.6	14.2	16.3
Other current assets	6.6	6.6	6.6	6.6
Total current assets	103.7	112.6	137.0	173.6
Net PP&E	57.3	70.3	82.3	88.3
Net intangibles	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4
Total investments	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1
Other long-term assets	1.2	1.5	1.5	1.5
Total assets	162.7	184.9	221.4	263.9
Accounts payable	4.3	2.8	3.7	4.3
Short-term debt	—	—	—	—
Short-term lease liabilities	—	—	—	—
Other current liabilities	10.6	10.6	10.6	10.6
Total current liabilities	14.9	13.4	14.3	14.9
Long-term debt	0.0	0.0	—	—
Long-term lease liabilities	—	—	—	—
Other long-term liabilities	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6
Total long-term liabilities	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6
Total liabilities	15.4	13.9	14.9	15.4
Preferred shares	—	—	—	—
Total common equity	147.3	171.0	206.5	248.5
Minority interest	--	--	--	--
Total liabilities & equity	162.7	184.9	221.4	263.9
Net debt, adjusted	(67.3)	(86.6)	(104.5)	(137.2)

Cash Flow (¥ bn)

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Net income	18.2	25.1	37.6	44.6
D&A add-back	5.3	7.0	8.0	9.0
Minority interest add-back	—	—	—	—
Net (inc)/dec working capital	(4.3)	9.0	(5.7)	(3.3)
Other operating cash flow	(2.3)	—	—	—
Cash flow from operations	16.9	41.1	39.9	50.3
Capital expenditures	(22.5)	(20.0)	(20.0)	(15.0)
Acquisitions	—	—	—	—
Divestitures	0.0	—	—	—
Others	0.7	—	—	—
Cash flow from investing	(21.8)	(20.0)	(20.0)	(15.0)
Repayment of lease liabilities	—	—	—	—
Dividends paid (common & pref)	(1.3)	(1.4)	(2.1)	(2.6)
Inc/(dec) in debt	—	—	—	—
Other financing cash flows	1.5	(0.4)	0.0	0.0
Cash flow from financing	0.2	(1.7)	(2.1)	(2.6)
Total cash flow	(4.6)	19.3	17.8	32.7
Free cash flow	(5.6)	21.1	19.9	35.3

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

Exhibit 1: Our FY3/27-FY3/29 old vs. new estimates

(mn JPY)

Revenue	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
As of Sep 7th	93,300	124,000	142,500
New	93,300	125,000	143,500
% change	0%	1%	1%

Revenue by segment	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Telecommunication			
As of Sep 7th	48,000	76,000	91,000
New	48,000	76,000	91,000
% change	0%	0%	0%

AI			
As of Sep 7th	32,000	60,000	75,000
New	32,000	60,000	75,000
% change	0%	0%	0%

ex. AI			
As of Sep 7th	16,000	16,000	16,000
New	16,000	16,000	16,000
% change	0%	0%	0%

Auto			
As of Sep 7th	14,000	15,000	16,000
New	14,000	15,000	16,000
% change	0%	0%	0%

SPE			
As of Sep 7th	12,000	13,000	15,000
New	12,000	14,000	16,000
% change	0%	8%	7%

Industrial equipment			
As of Sep 7th	8,000	8,400	8,800
New	8,000	8,400	8,800
% change	0%	0%	0%

Lighting			
As of Sep 7th	11,300	11,600	11,700
New	11,300	11,600	11,700
% change	0%	0%	0%

Operating Profit	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
As of Sep 7th	35,000	57,000	71,000
New	35,000	53,000	63,000
% change	0%	-7%	-11%

OP by segment	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Ceramic			
As of Sep 7th	34,900	56,700	70,500
New	34,800	52,800	62,700
% change	0%	-7%	-11%

Lighting			
As of Sep 7th	2,400	2,600	2,800
New	2,400	2,600	2,800
% change	0%	0%	0%

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Outlook by application

- **Telecommunications:** Our 2Q-4Q3/27 AI-related sales estimates are ¥7.5 bn/¥8.5 bn/¥10 bn (1Q was ¥6 bn). We expect solid qoq sales growth in 2Q toward our full-year estimate of ¥32 bn. For non-AI telecommunication applications, we forecast flat yoy full-year sales. However, smartphone-related sales in particular require close monitoring as they tend to experience quarterly volatility mainly due to timing differences in sales recognition.
- **Automotive:** We leave unchanged our estimate of quarterly sales of ¥3.5 bn for full-year sales of ¥14 bn. Management assumes room for upside to quarterly sales in 2H, driven by increased sales to emerging customer in China. If this were to materialize, it would lead to upside for sales in this application. We believe the risk of large fluctuations in automotive sales has decreased compared to before, as

MARUWA is constantly making progress in reducing its dependence on major Chinese customers.

- **Semiconductors:** The company's view and our forecast that this segment will enter a phase of full-fledged sales recovery and growth from 2Q remain unchanged. In quartz products for semiconductor production equipment, Ferrotec (Not Covered) is cited as one of the company's competitors. Ferrotec has revised up its FY12/26 earnings guidance due to rapid expansion in demand for ceramics and quartz products for semiconductor production equipment. Given that this appears to be an expansion in demand across the entire industry and not just MARUWA alone, we assume a high likelihood that MARUWA's semiconductor-related sales will finally recover starting in 2Q.

Earnings revisions/target price

We lower our FY3/28-FY3/29 operating profit estimates by 7%/11% (FY3/27E unchanged). The revisions mainly reflect higher costs associated with capacity expansion for AI applications. With the reduction in our operating profit/EBITDA estimates, we lower our 12-month target price to ¥81,000, from ¥90,000. Our new target price implies a P/E of 26.6X/22.4X based on our FY3/28-FY3/29 EPS estimates, which we view as a healthy valuation level in an environment of strong AI-related performance and limited downside risks for non-AI applications.

MARUWA

Investment Thesis - MARUWA

As a ceramics supplier, MARUWA's history dates back nearly 200 years. The company provides a wide range of ceramic products mainly for applications in fields such as (1) telecommunications, (2) autos, (3) semiconductors, and (4) industrial equipment. MARUWA has been transforming its business portfolio since the mid-2000s, shifting its focus from highly commoditized and cyclical products that face intense price-based competition to high-margin products for niche markets that require customization. Margins have improved sharply as a result, and MARUWA has won high share in niche markets with strong growth potential. It has established a structural competitive advantage enabling high growth, customization, margins, and market share. In FY3/27-FY3/29, we expect earnings growth to be driven mainly by heat-dissipation substrates for optical transceivers, as well as xEVs and quartz/SiC products for semiconductor production equipment. We are Buy rated on the stock, as we think earnings growth potential from FY3/27 is not fully factored into the current share price.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - MARUWA

We are Buy rated on MARUWA. Our 12-month target price is ¥81,000 (implies FY27/28E P/E of 27x/22x). Our target price is based on FY28E EBITDA, and we derive the applied multiple of 12.0X from the historical correlation between the EBITDA margin and the EV/EBITDA multiple. Key risks include lower investment in applications that support final demand (including AI/general-purpose servers, xEV, SPE), lower demand for end

products due to supply chain disruptions and inventory adjustments, and the emergence of alternative technology.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Mitsuhiro Icho and Daiki Takayama, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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Financial Returns and Multiple use the Goldman Sachs analyst forecasts at the fiscal year-end at least three quarters in the future. Growth uses inputs for the fiscal year at least seven quarters in the future compared with the year at least three quarters in the future (on a per-share basis for all metrics).

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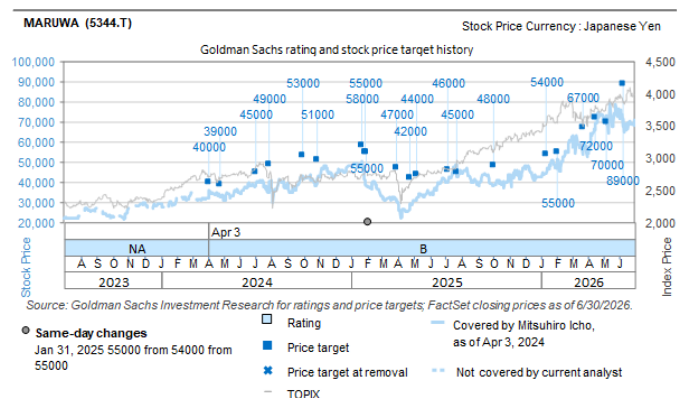
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Goldman Sachs Investment Research global Equity coverage universe

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	Buy	Hold	Sell		Buy	Hold	Sell
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



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Target price history table(s)

MARUWA (5344.T)

Date of report Target price (¥) Closing price (¥)

06-Sep-26	90,000	53,510
08-Jun-26	89,000	67,750
08-May-26	70,000	68,930
16-Apr-26	72,000	69,200
23-Mar-26	67,000	53,790
03-Feb-26	55,000	51,620
12-Jan-26	54,000	44,550
02-Oct-25	48,000	38,170
24-Jul-25	45,000	46,930
07-Jul-25	46,000	40,020
08-May-25	44,000	32,210
25-Apr-25	42,000	29,375
31-Mar-25	47,000	30,320
01-Feb-25	55,000	38,320
31-Jan-25	54,000	38,320
29-Jan-25	55,000	40,900
22-Jan-25	58,000	50,150
29-Oct-24	51,000	41,650
01-Oct-24	53,000	43,300
29-Jul-24	49,000	40,500
02-Jul-24	45,000	38,300
25-Apr-24	39,000	33,300
03-Apr-24	40,000	32,350

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